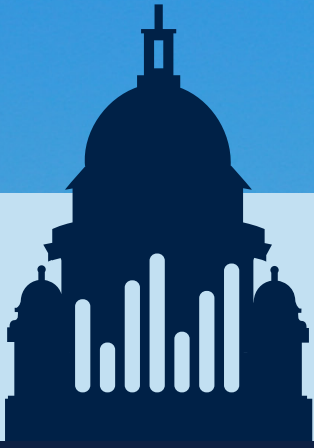




THE RHODE ISLAND SURVEY INITIATIVE
URI HARRINGTON SCHOOL OF COMMUNICATION AND MEDIA
UNIVERSITY OF RHODE ISLAND COLLEGE OF ARTS AND SCIENCES

Housing and Governance in Rhode Island



Photo by: Quintin Soloviev

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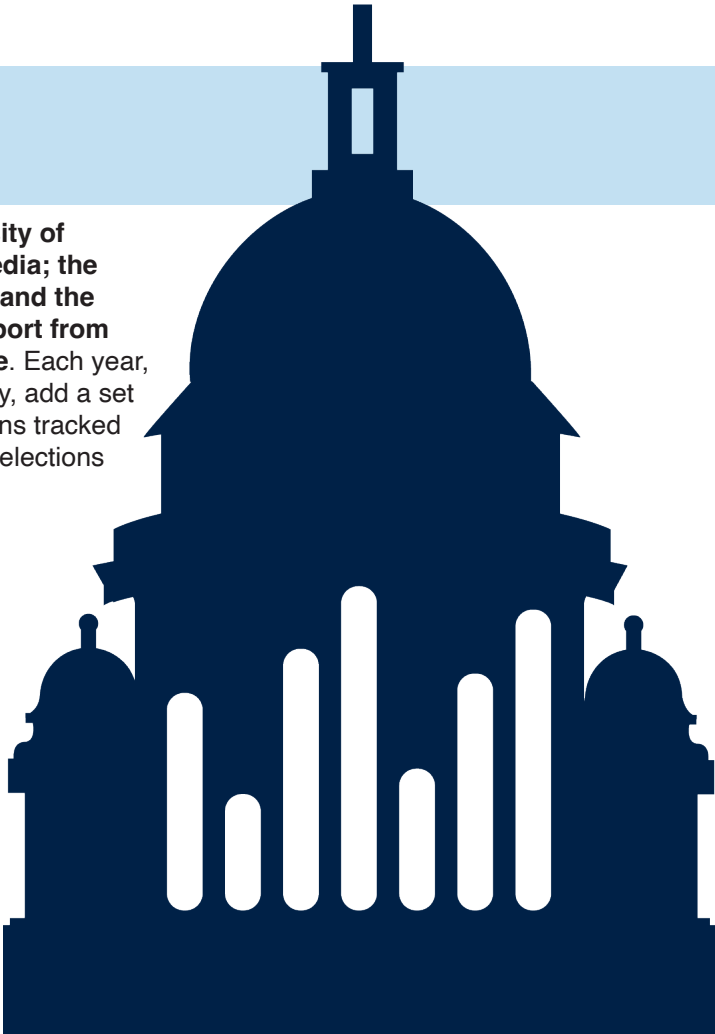
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ABOUT

The Rhode Island Survey Initiative (RISI) is led by the University of Rhode Island’s Harrington School for Communication and Media; the Social Science Institute for Research, Education, and Policy; and the Department of Political Science. RISI receives additional support from the John Hazen White Sr. Center for Ethics and Public Service. Each year, URI faculty and students select one major theme for in-depth study, add a set of timely current-events items, and retain a core battery of questions tracked annually. Previous RISI major themes were education (2023) and elections (2024); for RISI 2025, the major theme is housing.

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SUMMARY OF FINDINGS



METHODOLOGY

The third annual survey (2025) was administered online by YouGov, an international market-research and data-analytics firm, from August 1 to August 18, 2025, and includes N=500 Rhode Island adults (18+). Respondents were matched to a statewide sampling frame and the final data were weighted to known targets for gender, age, race/ethnicity, education, and region. The estimated margin of error for the full sample is ± 6.01 percentage points. Not all survey questions are presented in this report; topline results with full question wording appear at the end of the document.

PERCEPTIONS OF HOUSING

A strong majority (93%) of Rhode Islanders saw housing costs as a problem, especially those with lower incomes. About one-third of all respondents report falling behind on utility bills, and roughly one-quarter fell behind on rent or a mortgage. Many non-owners still hope to buy, but the top roadblock is price, followed by interest rates, credit scores, and property taxes. There are somewhat competing narratives on why costs are high. Renters and other non-owners are more likely to point to landlord price hikes and too little public investment, while homeowners cite inflation-driven factors such as rising construction costs, high mortgage rates, and out-of-state buyers.

WHAT AND WHERE TO BUILD

The most popular solutions to the housing crisis focus on using what already exists: repairing existing affordable units and turning vacant or underused buildings into housing. Building more homes for middle- and low-income families also ranks fairly high. By contrast, zoning changes draw far less enthusiasm. Few point to zoning as a main reason prices are high, and only a slim plurality back reforms like allowing more multi-family housing, smaller lots near transit, or allowing more accessory dwelling units and multi-family conversions.

Support is strong for shelters and public housing being built statewide, but it drops off sharply when people are asked about having them in their own neighborhood - a classic case of “NIMBYism” (“Not in My Back Yard”). The biggest gap is for homeless shelters: they top the list of housing types residents want to see built across Rhode Island (81% support), yet fall to the bottom when the question shifts to their own neighborhoods (17% support). At the same time, respondents are clear that whole towns shouldn’t block affordable housing. When local governments say “no” to affordable housing, a solid majority (65%) want the state to step in with consequences - though views differ on exactly what those consequences should be.

WHO SHOULD BUILD

When asked who should take the lead on building, the most popular answer was for the state to partner with non-profits (66% support). A majority (54%) also back a public developer model, where the state itself builds and directly sells affordable housing. This idea, sometimes called the “Montgomery Model,” has been discussed by leaders across the political spectrum in Rhode Island. Partnerships with private developers received thinner support (41%) and were the least preferred option overall.

SUMMARY OF FINDINGS



HOUSING POLICY MENU

Concerns about landlord price hikes line up with broad support (72%) for rent stabilization, including caps on annual increases. Other ideas that drew support include expanding vouchers (64%), providing free IDs and birth certificates for unhoused minors, and prioritizing Narragansett Tribe households for affordable housing near ancestral lands.

OTHER POLITICS AND POLICY

Our survey also included several questions on current political and policy debates in Rhode Island beyond housing. Most residents (65%) say they've felt little or no direct impact from the Washington Bridge closure and reconstruction, though those living in cities closest to the bridge report greater disruption. When it comes to blame, respondents point first to RIDOT leadership past and present and to state-hired inspection firms. Looking ahead to the 2026 Democratic primary for governor, the field is wide open. Four in ten respondents remain undecided, and the four most frequently named contenders are essentially neck and neck.

On gun policy, an assault-weapons ban wins strong support (73%), however respondents strongly back the failed proposal that would have required owners to register weapons already purchased (63%).

When asked about policy priorities, health care rises to the top. Views split along partisan lines regarding some issues, such as crime and housing. When it comes to solving the primary care shortage, voters back multiple approaches, most notably establishing a URI medical school (75%) and forgiving loans for physicians who stay in Rhode Island (71%).

MEDIA USE

We continue to track Rhode Islanders' media habits and see little change from 2024. TV and news websites/apps remain the daily go-tos. On social media, most people read political content, but far fewer post or share it. Facebook and YouTube remain the leading sites for political news, and 26% say they don't use social media for political news at all. Rhode Islanders also feel confident about the news: large majorities say they understand how it's made, can interpret it, and can judge its quality.

PUBLIC OPINION TRENDS

Satisfaction with life in Rhode Island has remained stable since last year, as have views of the state's economy and the threat of political violence. Trust in local and state government has also held steady, with a clear majority continuing to express confidence in both. The one major change is at the national level: trust in the federal government has dropped noticeably compared to last year.

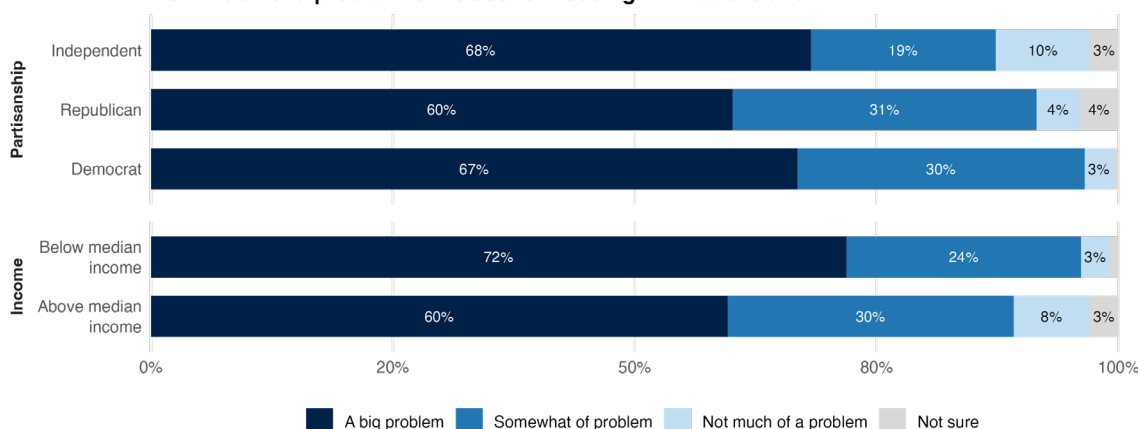


HOUSING PART 1: HOW BIG IS THE PROBLEM?

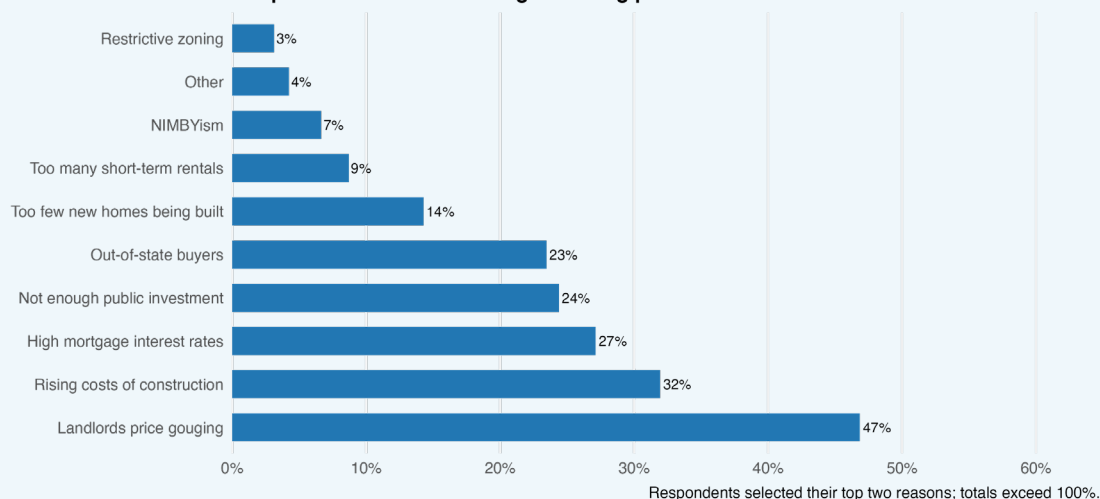
OVERVIEW

Respondents say housing costs are a problem - overwhelmingly, and across party lines. When pressed on causes, respondents most frequently pointed to landlords overall; owners lean toward cost pressures like construction and mortgage rates, while non-owners more often cite landlords and too little public investment.

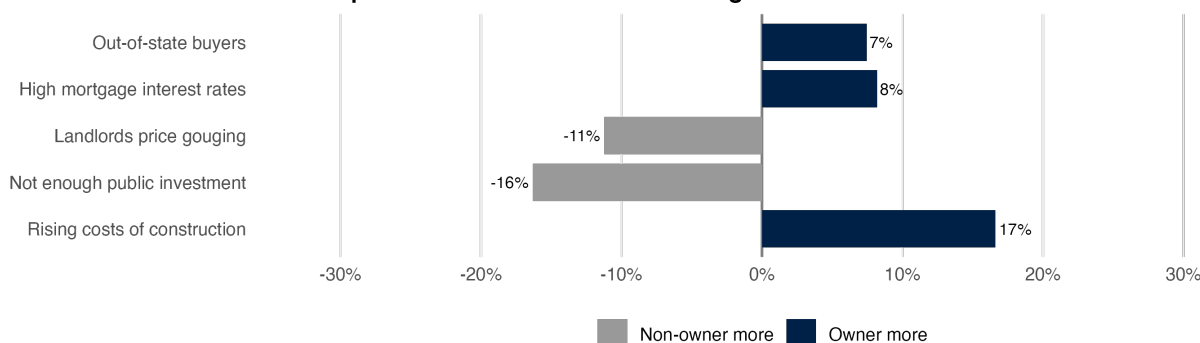
How much of a problem is the cost of housing in Rhode Island?



Respondents' reasons for high housing prices



Who emphasizes each reason for housing costs: owners vs. non-owners



Values show owner minus non-owner shares for top five reasons.

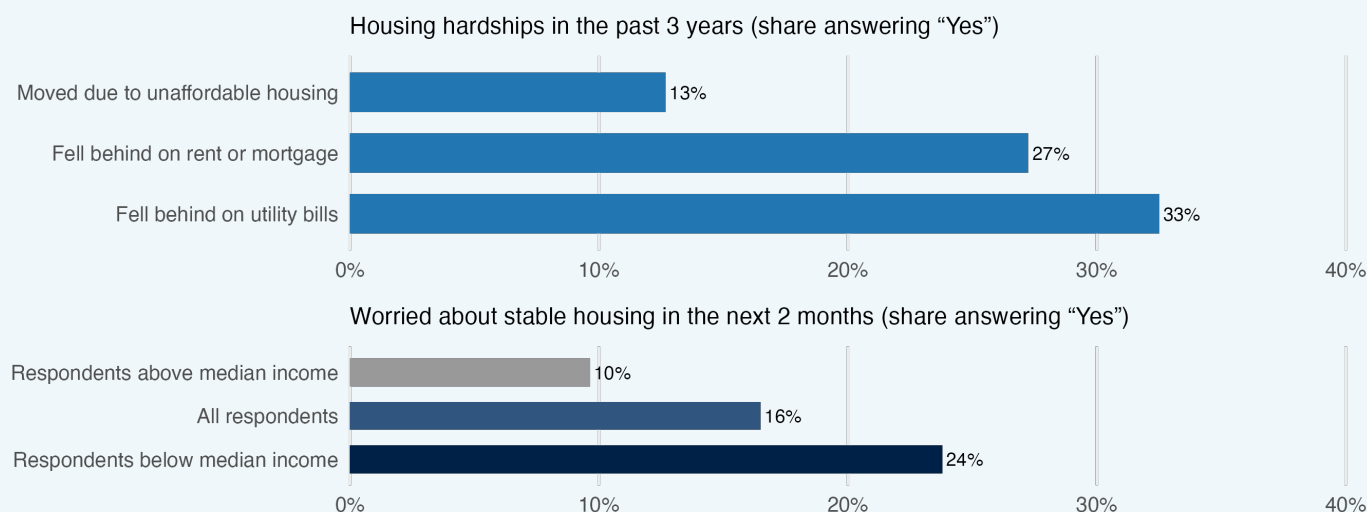


HOUSING PART 2: LIVED EXPERIENCE

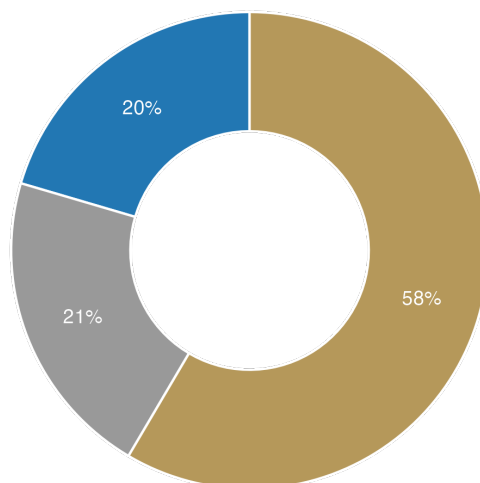
OVERVIEW

Housing strain is real: one-third report falling behind on utility bills and over one-quarter on rent or mortgages; worries about losing stable housing are highest among below-median-income residents. Most non-owners aren't planning to buy soon and cite prices first, with interest rates, credit access, and property taxes trailing. Among current owners, half used some kind of help - mainly first-time buyer programs and support from family.

Housing strain in Rhode Island



Do non-owners plan to buy a home in the next 2 years?



Yes Not sure No

Totals may not sum to 100% due to rounding.

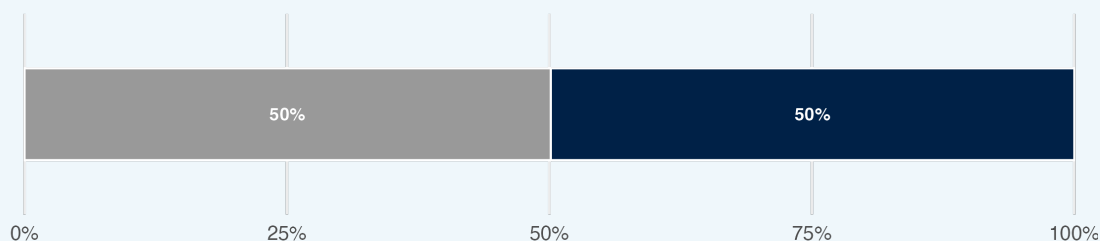
HOUSING PART 2: LIVED EXPERIENCE



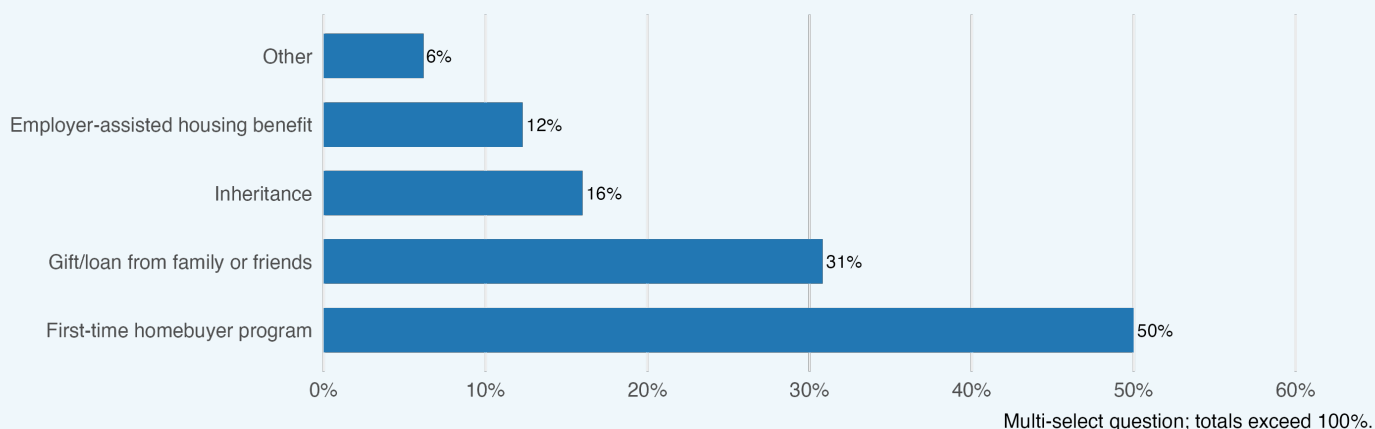
CONTINUED

Did homeowners receive purchase assistance?

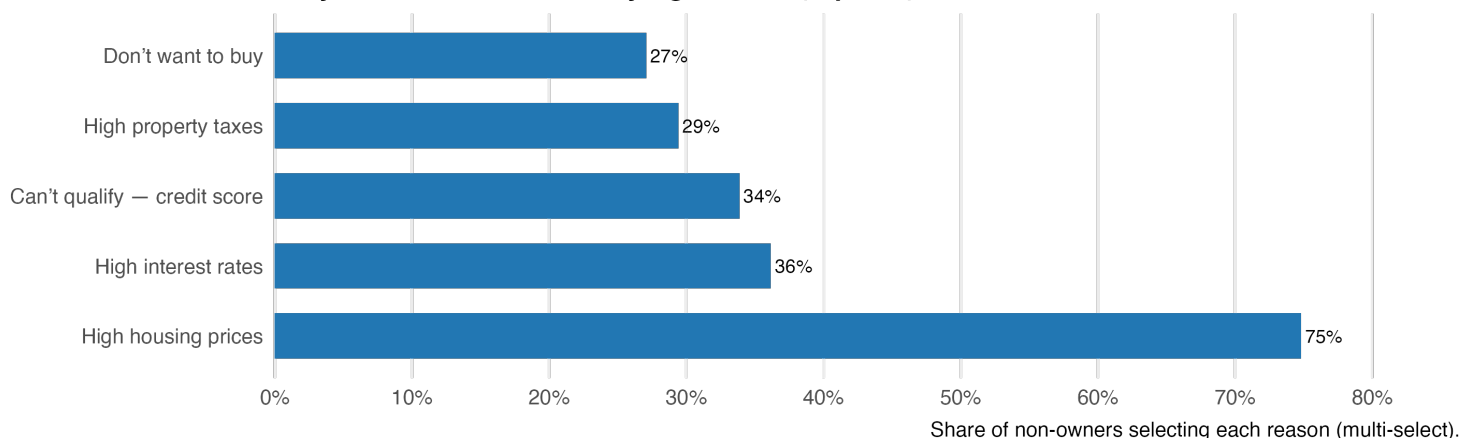
Homeowners who used any purchase assistance (among those asked)



Among owners who used assistance, which types were used?



Why non-owners aren't buying a home (top five)



HOUSING PART 3:

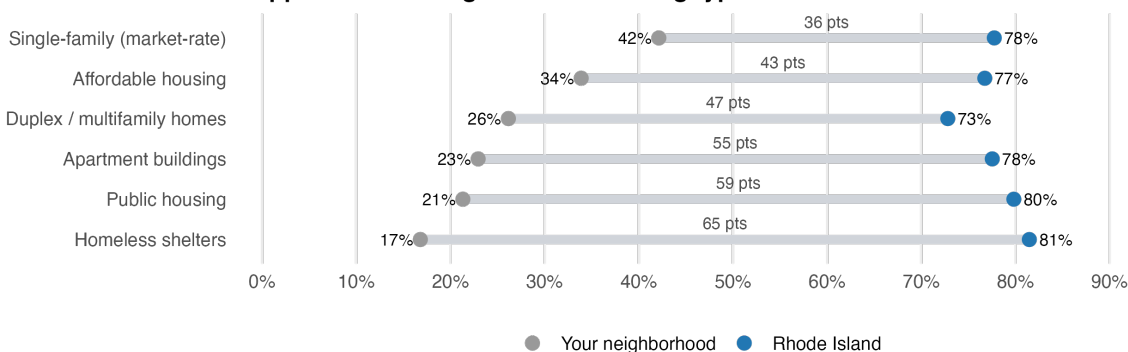
WHAT TO BUILD, WHO BUILDS IT, AND WHERE IT GOES



OVERVIEW

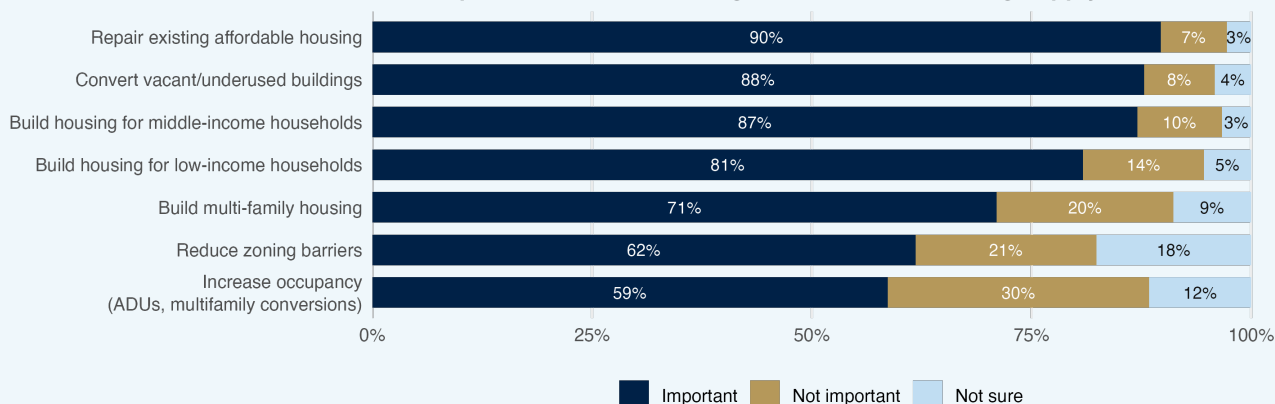
Respondents back new housing in Rhode Island generally, but support drops precipitously in their own neighborhoods - a phenomenon known as NIMBYism (Not in my backyard). They want to fix what we have and reuse empty buildings, with strong support for constructing more homes for middle- and low-income families. On delivery, non-profit partnerships lead, though the public developer model has a solid majority of support.

Support for building different housing types

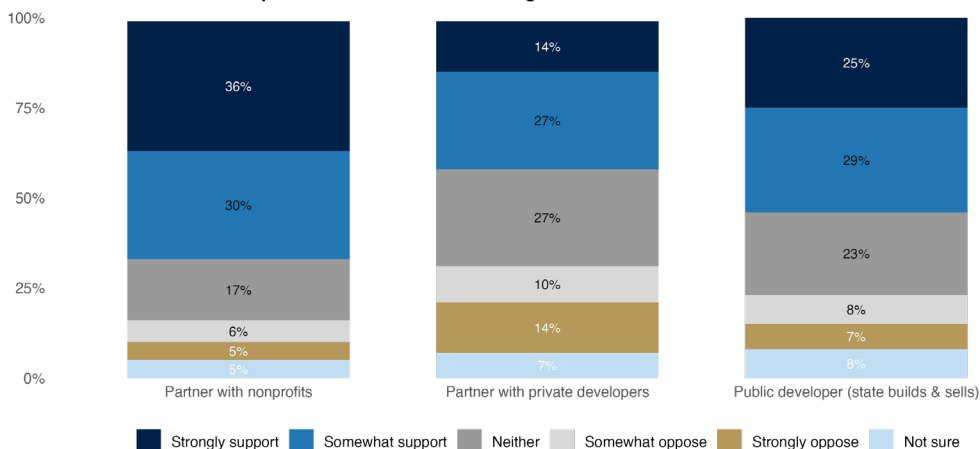


Percents are shares answering yes for RI generally and for own neighborhood.

How important are these strategies to increase housing supply?



Who should the state partner with to build housing?



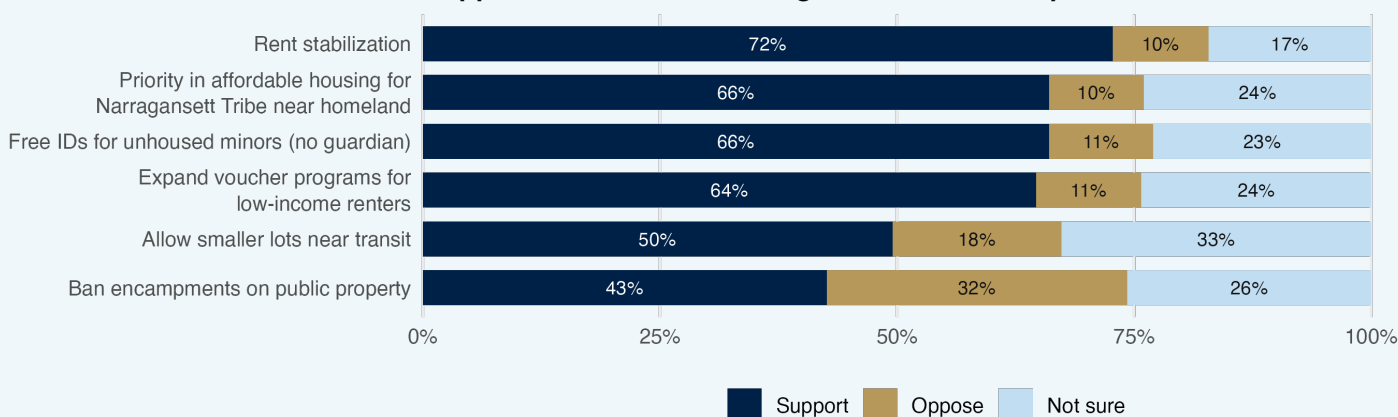


HOUSING PART 4: POLICY

OVERVIEW

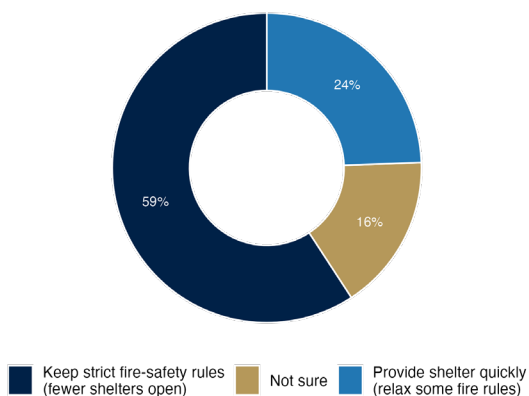
Rhode Islanders want the state to act when a town blocks affordable housing: 65% favor some consequence. Among those who want action, cutting state aid is the preferred approach. Beyond that, there's broad support for rent stabilization and for some equity-focused steps like priority access for Narragansett tribal members near ancestral land and IDs/birth certificates for unhoused minors without a guardian signature.

Support for selected housing & homelessness policies

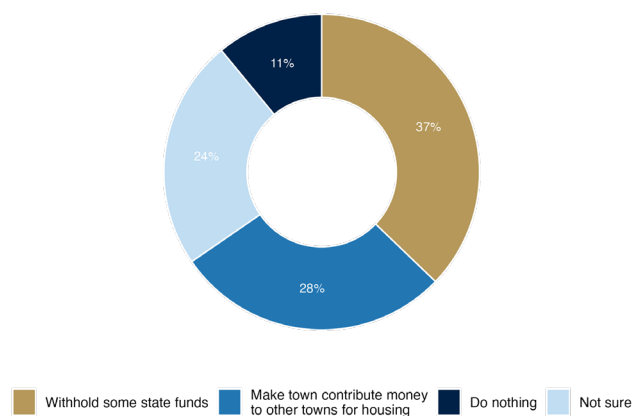


Emergency shelters: speed or safety?

Pallet shelters were delayed in part due to fire-safety rules. Should RI relax some rules to open shelters faster, or keep strict rules even if openings are slower in winter?



If a town blocks affordable housing, what should the state do?



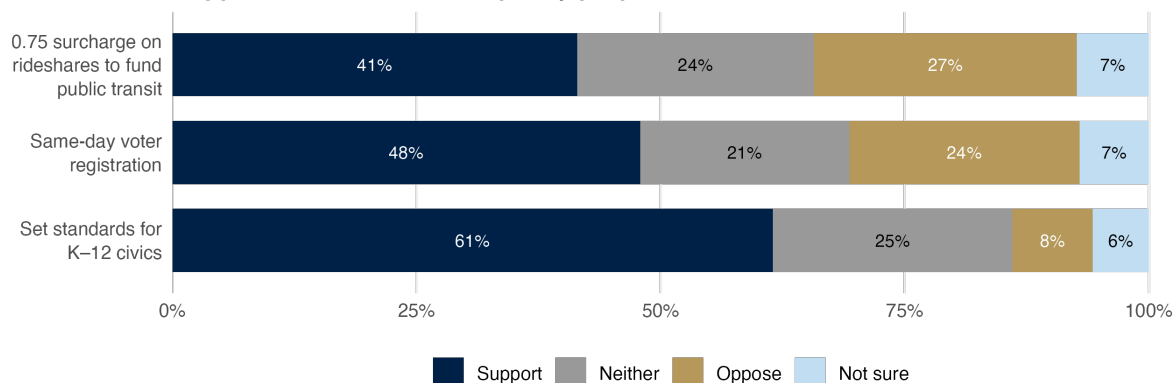
POLICY DEBATES: MISCELLANEOUS



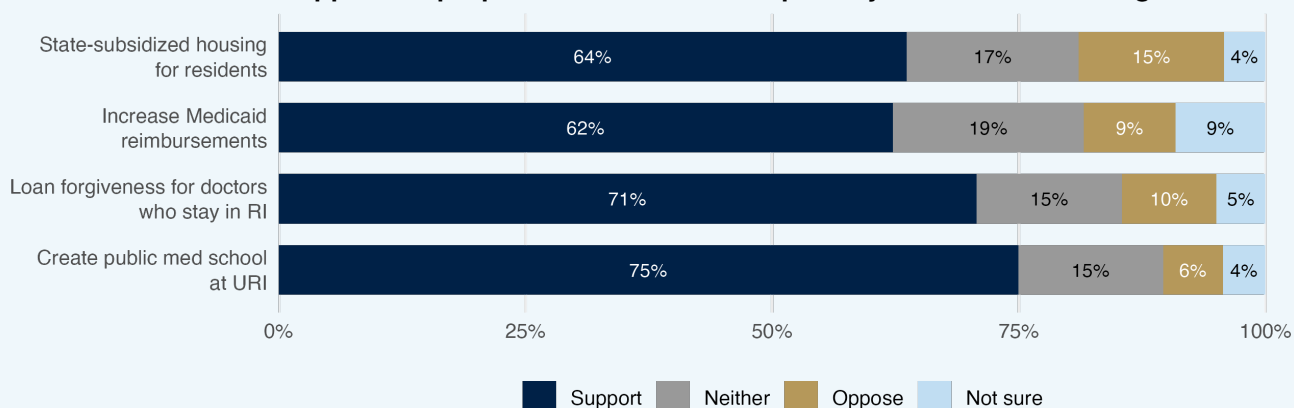
OVERVIEW

A majority of respondents support setting statewide K–12 civics standards, while same-day voter registration divides opinion at 48% support. On guns, three-quarters favor an assault-weapons ban, with the largest share backing the proposal to require registration of existing assault-style weapons. To address the state's primary-care shortage, respondents endorsed every option proposed - especially creating a public medical school at URI and loan-forgiveness for doctors who remain in Rhode Island.

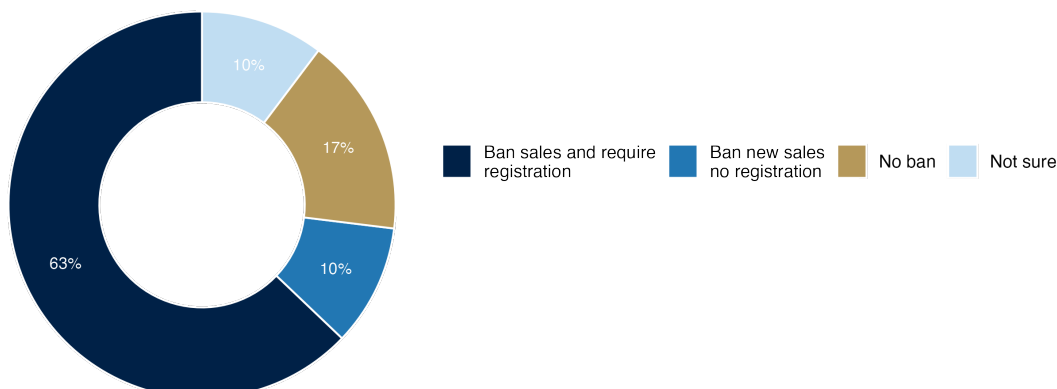
Support for miscellaneous policy proposals



Support for proposals to address RI's primary-care doctor shortage



Preferred assault-weapons policy



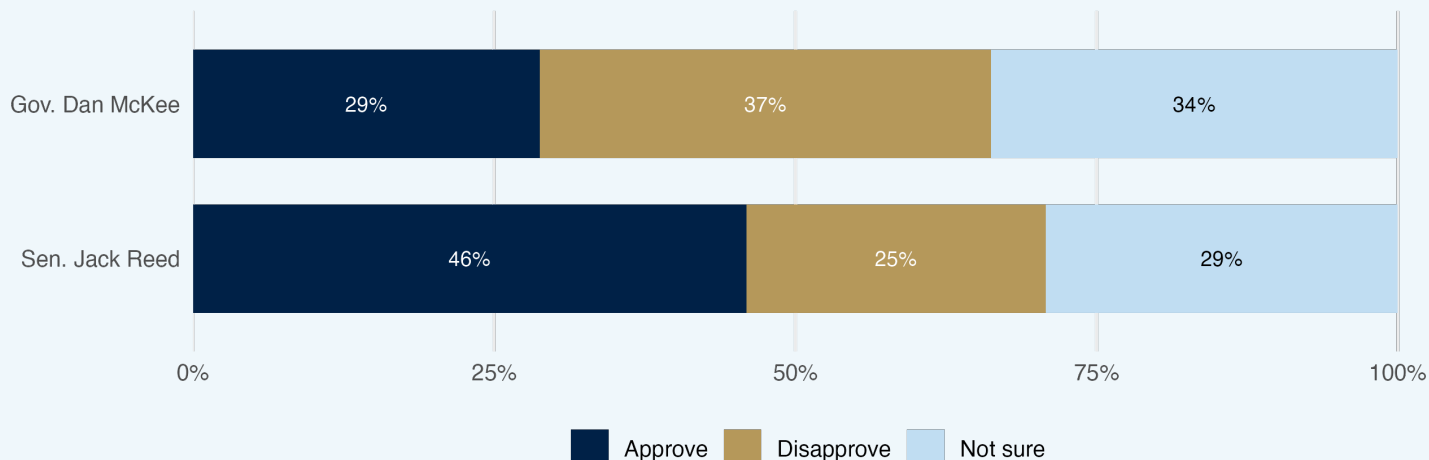


VIEW OF THE TOP

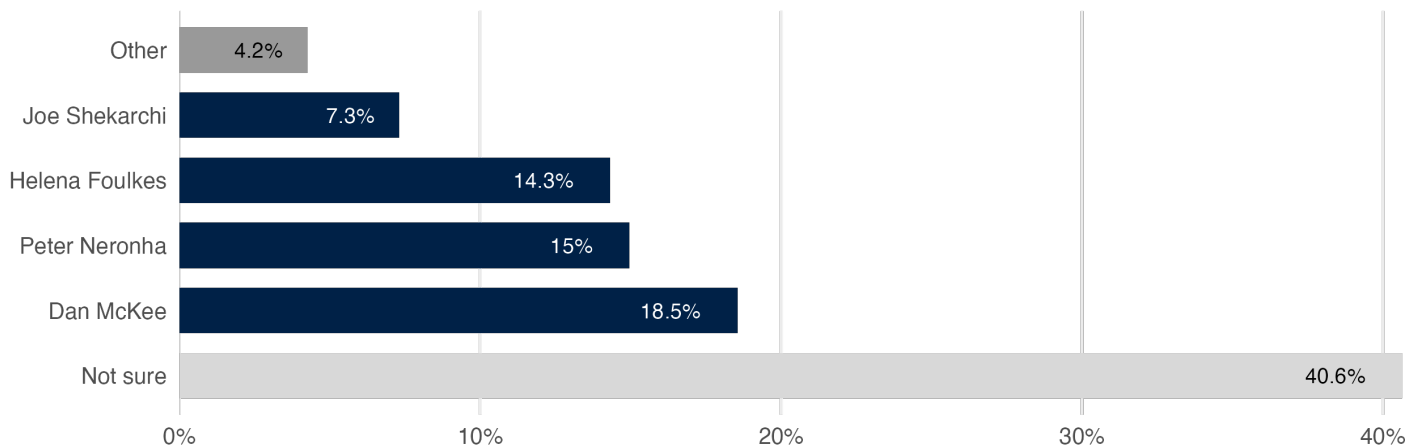
OVERVIEW

Governor Dan McKee's approval rating stands at 29%, while Senator Jack Reed's is stronger at 46%. In the Democratic primary, among Democrats and Independents who are registered to vote, "not sure" leads at 40.6%. All of the most widely discussed potential candidates sit below 20%.

Approval ratings



2026 Democratic primary choice for governor



Note: Registered Democrats and Independents only.

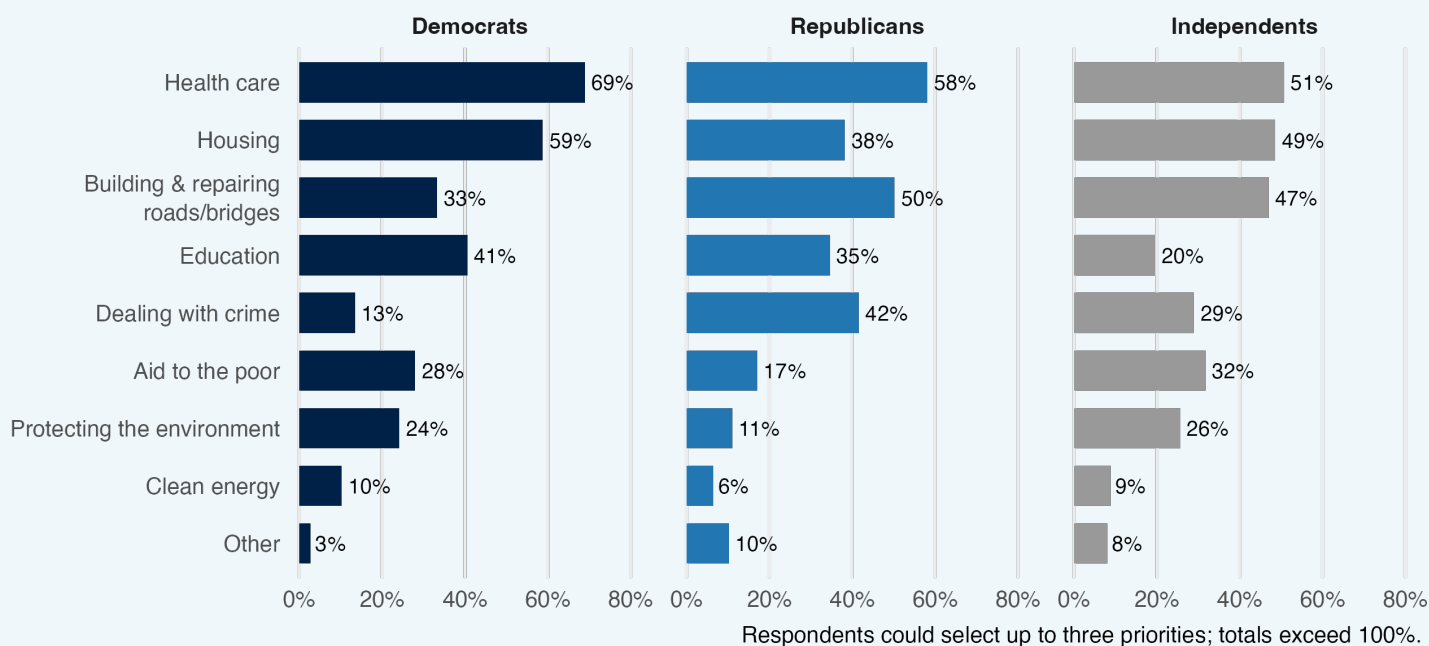
WHAT SHOULD THE STATE DO NEXT?



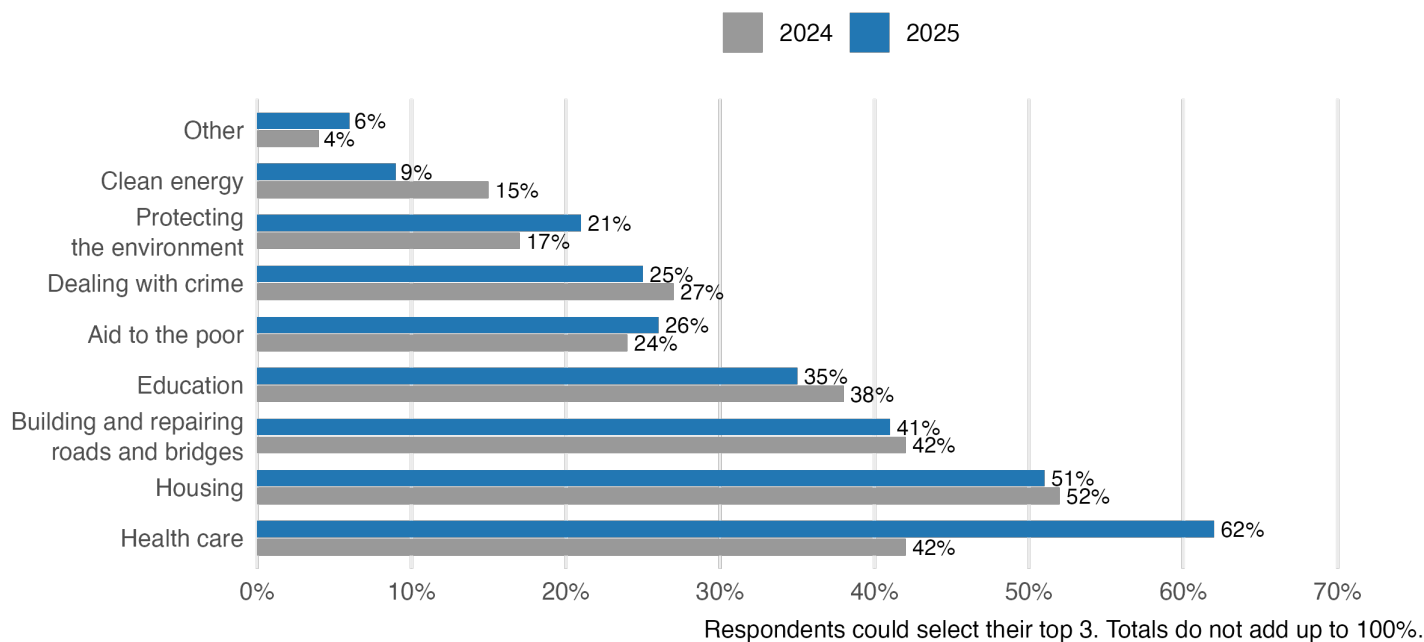
OVERVIEW

Health care rockets to the top of the to-do list for the Governor and General Assembly. Partisans are split on other issues including housing and crime.

Top policy priorities for governor and General Assembly (2025)



Top priorities for the RI governor and General Assembly, 2024 vs 2025



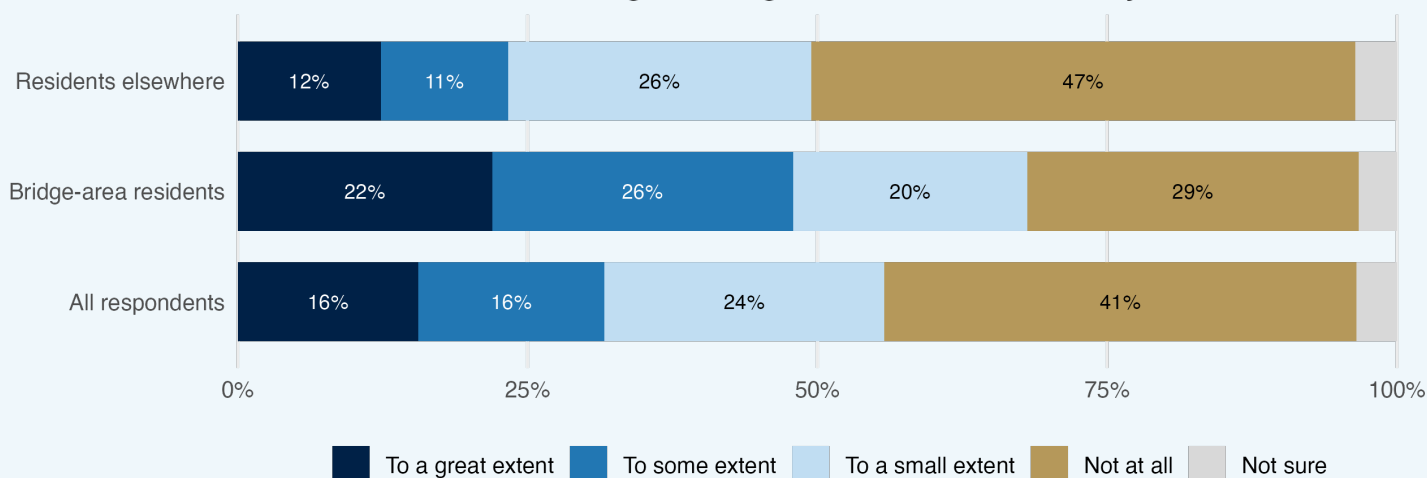
WASHINGTON BRIDGE: IMPACT AND ACCOUNTABILITY



OVERVIEW

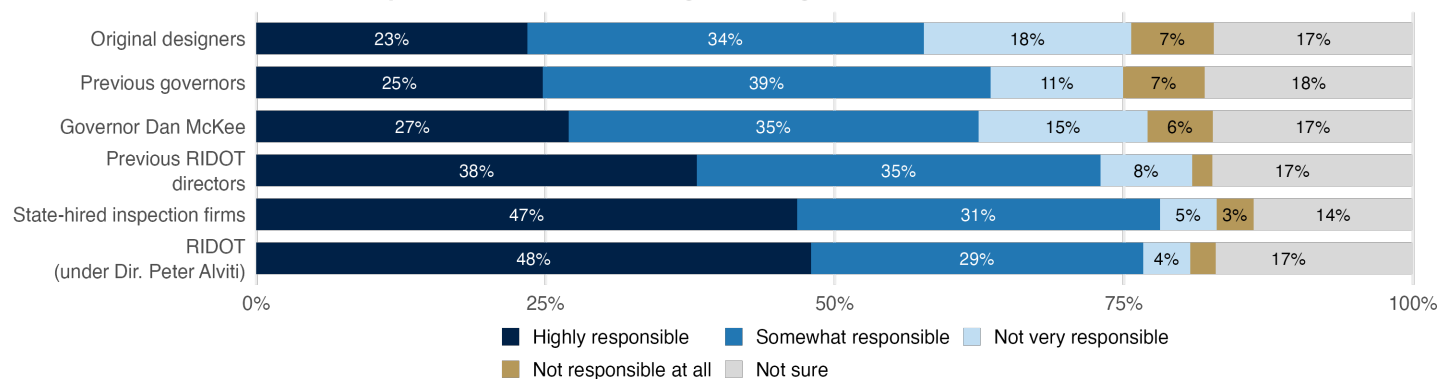
Most Rhode Islanders report little or no direct disruption from the Washington Bridge reconstruction, but residents in the nearby corridor are much more likely to say it has affected their daily life. Accountability is spread across multiple actors with RIDOT under director Peter Alviti, state-hired inspection firms, and prior RIDOT leadership drawing the largest shares of blame.

How much has the Washington Bridge construction affected your life?



Bridge-area residents include East Providence, Barrington, Warren, Bristol, Providence, Pawtucket, Central Falls, and North Providence.

Who is responsible for the Washington Bridge crisis?



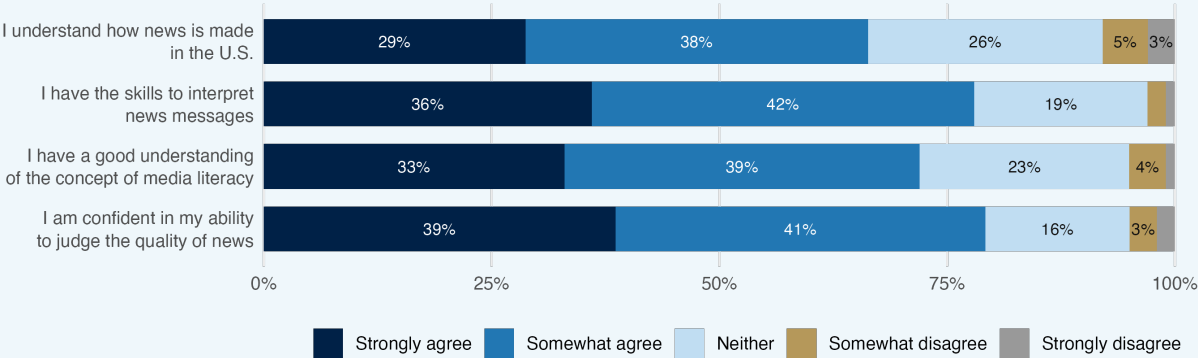


MEDIA USE

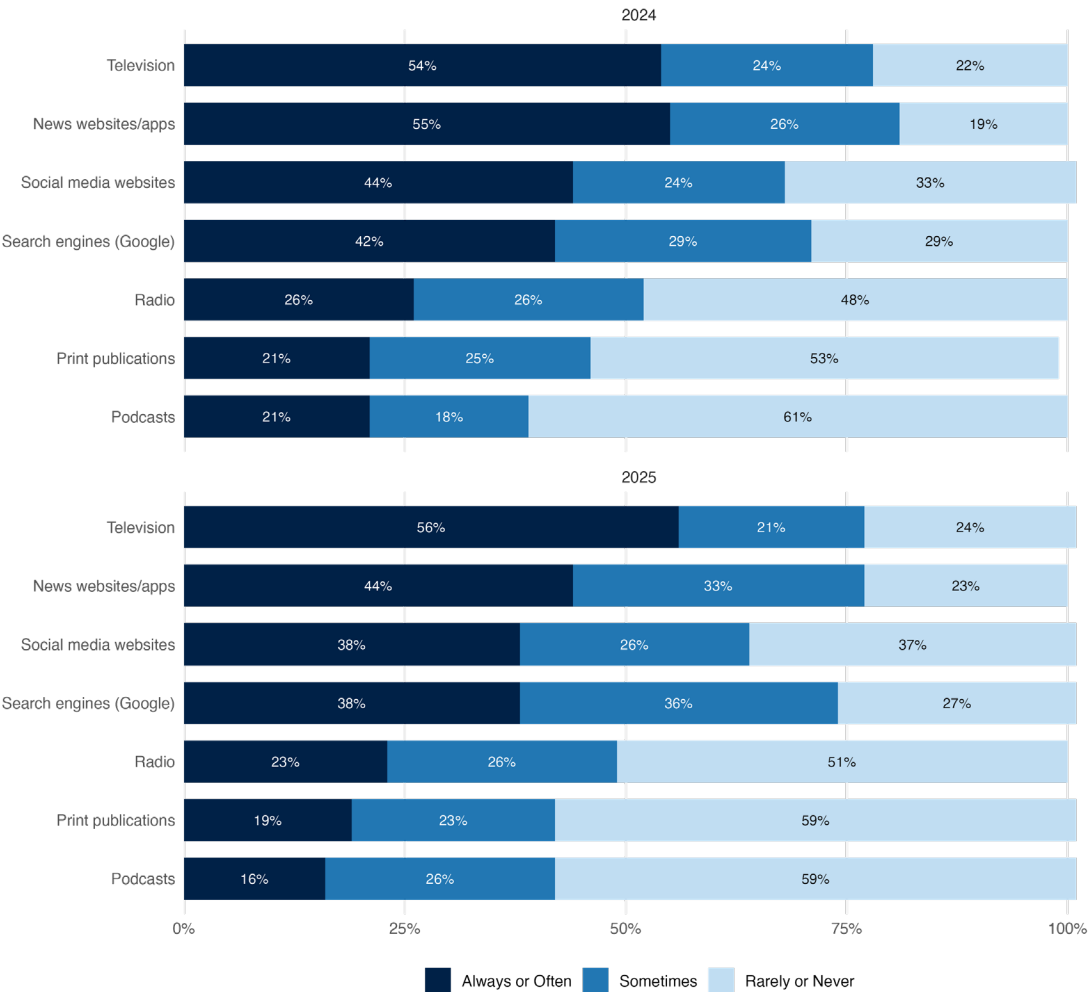
OVERVIEW

TV and news websites/apps remain the daily go-tos for political news. Rhode Islanders also feel confident about the news: large majorities say they understand how it's made, can interpret it, and can judge its quality.

Self-assessed media literacy



How often do Rhode Islanders get political/election news?



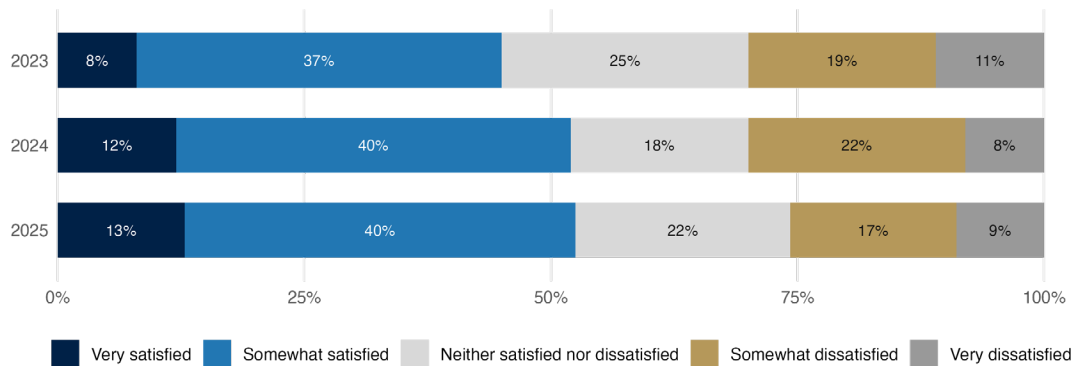
QUALITY OF LIFE, ECONOMY, AND TRUST IN GOV'T.



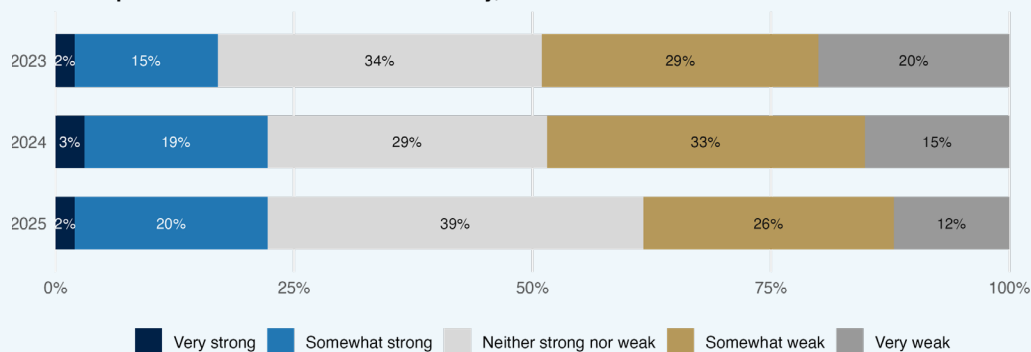
OVERVIEW

Rhode Islanders' views of life in the state and the economy remain steady, with little movement over the past three years. But trust tells a different story: while confidence in local and state government is holding firm, trust in the federal government has slipped in 2025.

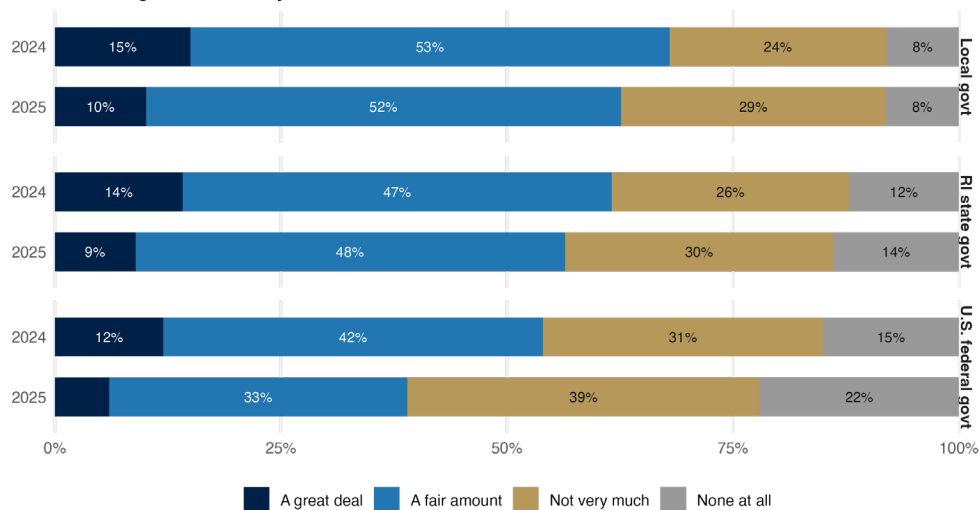
Quality of life in Rhode Island, 2023–2025



Perceptions of the Rhode Island economy, 2023–2025



Trust in government by level, 2024 vs 2025



Note: Totals may not sum to 100% due to rounding.

Section 1: Perceptions of RI's Housing Situation¹

Generally speaking, do you think that the cost of housing in Rhode Island is...

Response option	Percent
A big problem	65%
Somewhat of a problem	28%
Not much of a problem	5%
Not sure	2%

What do you think are the top two factors driving up housing prices in Rhode Island? Please select up to two (2) options.

Response option	Percent
Landlords price gouging	47%
Rising costs of construction	32%
High mortgage interest rates	27%
Not enough public investment	24%
Out-of-state buyers	23%
Too few new homes being built	14%
Too many short-term rentals	9%
NIMBYism	7%
Other	4%
Restrictive zoning	3%

¹ Note: In the following tables, percentages may not total 100% due to rounding. The response option "neither support nor oppose" is abbreviated as "neither."



Section 2: Respondents' Housing Situation

Have you experienced any of the following in the last three years? Please indicate whether each statement applies to you.

Item	Yes	No	Prefer not to say
Fell behind on rent or mortgage payments	27%	71%	1%
Fell behind on utility payments (such as electric, gas, or water bills)	33%	67%	1%
Moved because you could no longer afford your rent or mortgage	13%	84%	3%

What best describes your primary housing arrangement?

Response option	Percent
I own	64%
I rent	28%
I live with family or friends without paying rent	6%
I am unhoused/homeless	< 1%
Other	< 1%

Which of the following best describes your current primary home?

Response option	Percent
A detached single-family home	62%
An apartment in a multifamily home	19%
An apartment within a larger apartment building	10%
A townhouse	4%
Other	3%
A mobile home	2%
A rented room within another home	< 1%
A dorm or student housing	< 1%

Are you concerned that in the next two months you may not have stable housing?

Response option	Percent
Yes	17%
No	80%
Prefer not to say	4%



Do you plan to buy a home in the next 2 years?

Asked of non-homeowners only.

Response option	Percent
Yes	20%
No	58%
Not sure	21%

What are the reasons why you are not currently a homeowner?

Asked of non-homeowners only. Select all that apply.

Response option	Percent
High housing prices	75%
High interest rates	36%
Poor credit score affecting ability to secure a home loan	34%
High property taxes	29%
I do not want to buy a house	27%
High maintenance costs	26%
Other	6%
I experienced discrimination when trying to buy a home	4%

What financial assistance, if any, did you use to acquire your home?

Asked of homeowners only. Select all that apply.

Response option	Percent
None of the above	50%
First-time homebuyer program	25%
Gift or loan from family or friends	15%
Inheritance	8%
Employer-assisted housing benefit	6%
Other	3%



Section 3: Housing Preferences

Suppose you had to move out of your current home. For each housing option listed below, say whether you'd be willing to live in it in Rhode Island if it were the only option—or whether that would make you consider leaving the state to find better housing.

Housing option	Willing to live in R.I.	Would move out of state
Single-family detached house	77%	23%
Multifamily house	49%	51%
Condominium	58%	42%
Apartment	59%	41%
Accessory dwelling unit (ADU) on someone else's property	35%	65%
Group living arrangement	18%	82%
Mobile home	40%	60%

Different types of housing are suitable in different situations. Would you support building the following types of housing in each of these places? For each type of housing below, check the box if you would support building it in Rhode Island generally, in your city/town, and/or in your neighborhood. Leave the box blank if you would not support it.

Housing type	Rhode Island	Your city/town	Your neighborhood
Single-family market-rate homes	78%	50%	42%
Duplex/multifamily homes	73%	50%	26%
Apartment buildings	78%	43%	23%
Affordable housing	77%	50%	34%
Public housing	80%	38%	21%
Homeless shelters	81%	37%	17%



How important do you think it is for the state of Rhode Island to focus on the following strategies to increase housing supply?

Strategy	Very important	Important	Not too important	Not important at all	Not sure
Converting vacant or under-used buildings into housing (former commercial, schools, etc.)	46%	41%	6%	2%	4%
Increasing occupancy of existing housing (e.g., allowing more accessory units or conversions to multifamily)	21%	37%	23%	7%	12%
Reducing zoning barriers to allow more housing	20%	42%	13%	8%	18%
Building more multi-family housing (apartments, town-homes, duplexes)	24%	47%	15%	5%	9%
Building more affordable housing for low-income households	45%	36%	12%	2%	5%
Building more housing for middle-income households	44%	43%	8%	2%	3%
Repairing existing affordable housing	49%	41%	6%	2%	3%

To what extent do you support or oppose the following government-led approaches to the housing crisis in Rhode Island?

Approach	Strongly support	Somewhat support	Neither	Somewhat oppose	Strongly oppose	Not sure
Investing in a public developer model, where the state builds and sells affordable housing	25%	29%	23%	8%	7%	8%
Partnering with nonprofit organizations to build and sell affordable housing	36%	30%	17%	5%	5%	6%
Relying on private developers to build and sell affordable housing	14%	27%	27%	14%	10%	7%



There are many possible ways Rhode Island could try to address rising rents. Please tell us how much you would support or oppose each of the following approaches.

Approach	Strongly support	Somewhat support	Neither	Somewhat oppose	Strongly oppose	Not sure
Strict rent control: Capping rents at a fixed amount with little to no increases allowed	35%	24%	20%	8%	7%	5%
Rent stabilization: Placing limits on how much rent can increase each year (such as 2–3%)	49%	23%	11%	5%	5%	6%
Expand voucher programs: Increasing funding and availability of programs that provide funds to lower-income households for market-rate apartments	34%	30%	17%	6%	5%	7%
Expand “circuit breaker” tax credits: Provide tax relief to more lower-income households who struggle to afford market-rate apartments	34%	33%	15%	5%	4%	8%

Last fall, West Warwick passed an ordinance that prohibits camping or sleeping on public property. At the same time, shelter space remains limited. Supporters of the ordinance say it is needed to protect public health, safety, and quality of life. Opponents say this has scattered many people experiencing homelessness and has made outreach more challenging. To what extent do you support or oppose banning encampments on public property?

Approach	Strongly support	Somewhat support	Neither	Somewhat oppose	Strongly oppose	Not sure
Banning encampments on public property	23%	20%	21%	21%	11%	5%

Rhode Island law sets a goal that at least 10% of homes or 15% of rentals in each city and town should be affordable for low- and moderate-income residents. Do you think this goal is...

Response option	Percent
Too high	9%
Too low	34%
About right	27%
Should vary by community	23%
Not sure	7%



Johnston recently used eminent domain to seize land that had been set aside for an affordable housing project. That action is being challenged in court. Which of the following do you think should be the Rhode Island government's primary response in situations where local officials block affordable housing projects like this?

Response option	Percent
Do nothing. Local governments should be able to control affordable housing decisions by any legal means they choose.	11%
Require towns that block affordable housing to contribute money to build affordable housing in other cities and towns.	28%
Withhold some state funds from local governments until they demonstrate they are working toward the 10% affordable housing requirement.	37%
Not sure	24%

The ECHO Village pallet shelter site in Providence opened nearly a year late, partly due to fire safety concerns and the need for fire suppression systems in each unit. Some housing advocates want to relax fire codes to speed up winter shelter openings, while others worry this could compromise safety. Which statement comes closer to your view?

Response option	Percent
It is more important to provide shelter quickly even if that means relaxing some fire safety rules.	24%
It is more important to maintain strict fire safety regulations, even if that means fewer emergency shelters can open during the winter months.	59%
Not sure	16%



Section 4: Rhode Island Policy and Politics

What do you think are the MOST IMPORTANT priorities for the governor and general assembly to address this year?

(Select your top three priorities.)

Priority	Percent
Health care	62%
Housing	51%
Building and repairing roads and bridges	41%
Education	35%
Aid to the poor	26%
Dealing with crime	25%
Protecting the environment	21%
Clean energy	9%
Other	6%

Do you approve or disapprove of the way Dan McKee is handling his job as Rhode Island Governor?

Response	Percent
Approve	29%
Disapprove	37%
Not sure	34%

Do you approve or disapprove of the way Jack Reed is handling his job as a U.S. Senator?

Response	Percent
Approve	46%
Disapprove	25%
Not sure	29%



Rhode Island lawmakers recently passed legislation restricting assault-style weapons. Two versions of the bill were introduced, with a key difference described below: The House version would have banned the sale of new assault-style weapons and required current owners to register their weapons. The Senate version, which ultimately passed, also bans the sale of new assault-style weapons but does not require current owners to register the weapons they already have. Which of the following comes closest to your view?

Response option	Percent
I prefer an assault weapons law that bans new sales and requires residents to register assault-style weapons that they already own.	63%
I prefer an assault weapons law that bans new sales but does not require residents to register assault-style weapons that they already own.	10%
I do not support an “assault weapons” ban.	17%
Not sure	10%

To what extent would you support or oppose each of the following proposals aimed at addressing Rhode Island’s primary care doctor shortage?

Proposal	Strongly support	Somewhat support	Neither	Somewhat oppose	Strongly oppose	Not sure
Create a public medical school at the University of Rhode Island (URI) to train more primary care doctors	50%	25%	15%	3%	3%	4%
Provide loan-forgiveness incentives to encourage primary care doctor graduates to stay and work in Rhode Island	42%	28%	15%	4%	5%	5%
Permanently increase Medicaid reimbursement rates for primary care doctors	34%	28%	19%	5%	5%	9%
Offer state-subsidized housing for primary care doctors doing their residency in Rhode Island	30%	34%	17%	8%	7%	4%



To what extent has the closure and reconstruction of the Washington Bridge affected your daily life?

Response option	Percent
To a great extent	16%
To some extent	16%
To a small extent	24%
Not at all	41%
Not sure	3%

To what extent do you believe the following people or groups are responsible for the Washington Bridge crisis?

Group/Person	Highly resp	Somewhat resp	Not very resp	Not resp at all	Not sure
Governor Dan McKee	27%	35%	15%	6%	17%
RI Dept of Transportation (RIDOT), headed by Director Peter Alviti	48%	29%	4%	2%	17%
State-hired inspection firms	47%	31%	5%	3%	14%
Previous governors	25%	39%	11%	7%	18%
Previous RIDOT directors	38%	35%	8%	2%	17%
Original bridge designers	23%	34%	18%	7%	17%

There's been growing speculation about who will run in the Democratic primary for governor in Rhode Island. If the following candidates were on the ballot, who would you vote for?

Note: Responses include only Democrats and Independents who are registered to vote.

Candidate	Percent
Not sure	40.6%
Incumbent Governor Dan McKee	18.5%
RI Attorney General Peter Neronha	15.0%
Former CVS Executive Helena Foulkes	14.3%
RI Speaker of the House Joe Shekarchi	7.3%
Other	4.2%



Please read the following proposals and tell us whether you support or oppose each.

Proposal	Strongly support	Somewhat support	Neither	Somewhat oppose	Strongly oppose	Not sure
Legislation that requires cities and towns to allow multifamily housing on lots currently zoned for single family units	15%	30%	24%	13%	11%	7%
Legislation that changes zoning to allow for building housing on smaller lots when near public transit	19%	31%	24%	9%	9%	9%
Legislation that allows minors experiencing homelessness to receive a state ID and copy of their birth certificate at no cost, without a guardian signature	44%	22%	17%	6%	5%	6%
Legislation that imposes a \$0.75 surcharge per rideshare trip (like Uber) and directs that revenue to funding public transportation	17%	25%	24%	13%	14%	7%
Legislation that sets state-level standards for grades K–12 for civics education (e.g., the history of Rhode Island and foundations of representative government)	33%	29%	25%	6%	2%	6%
An amendment to the state constitution that would remove the thirty (30) day voter registration requirement to vote and require that a voter be registered by, or on election day	23%	25%	21%	8%	16%	7%
Legislation to give members of the Narragansett Tribe priority in affordable housing programs, so they can stay on or near their ancestral lands	38%	28%	18%	5%	5%	6%



Section 5: Media

How often do you get political news from...

Source	Always	Often	Sometimes	Rarely	Never
Television	20%	36%	21%	12%	12%
Print publications (e.g., newspapers, magazines)	6%	13%	23%	27%	32%
Radio	7%	16%	26%	25%	26%
News websites or apps	17%	27%	33%	14%	9%
Social media websites, such as Facebook, YouTube, TikTok	12%	26%	26%	14%	23%
Search through Google or other search engines	14%	24%	36%	17%	10%
Podcasts	4%	12%	26%	18%	41%

During a typical week, which social media site(s) do you most frequently use to get political and election news? Select all that apply.

Response option	Percent
Facebook	43%
Instagram	28%
LinkedIn	9%
Nextdoor	6%
Pinterest	7%
Reddit	11%
Snapchat	8%
TikTok	27%
Tumblr	2%
Twitch	3%
X	17%
WhatsApp	3%
YouTube	41%
Truth Social	5%
Other	4%
None of the above	26%



How often do you engage in the following political activities on social media?

Activity	All the time	Often	Sometimes	Rarely	Never
View content about political and election news on social media	11%	17%	31%	17%	25%
Post content (e.g., video, text, image) about political and election news on social media	3%	9%	21%	19%	49%
Discuss political and election news with others on social media (e.g., comments, quote retweets)	4%	11%	24%	18%	43%
Share political and election news with others on social media	4%	12%	26%	14%	44%

Please indicate your level of agreement regarding the following statements.

Statement	Strongly agree	Somewhat agree	Neither agree nor disagree	Somewhat disagree	Strongly disagree
I have a good understanding of the concept of media literacy.	33%	39%	23%	4%	1%
I have the skills to interpret news messages.	36%	42%	19%	2%	1%
I understand how news is made in the U.S.	29%	38%	26%	5%	3%
I am confident in my ability to judge the quality of news.	39%	41%	16%	3%	2%



Imagine you had to choose one media source to get recent political and election news, which national or local source below would you select?

Response option	Percent
ABC6 (Channel 6)	4%
ABC World News Tonight	2%
Associated Press News (AP)	3%
BBC	3%
CBS Evening News	1%
CNN	6%
Fox News	13%
MSNBC	9%
NBC Nightly News	8%
Newsmax	2%
NPR, such as The Public's Radio, GBH, or WBUR	5%
One America News Network (OAN)	< 1%
Reuters	< 1%
The Boston Globe	1%
The Daily Wire	< 1%
The Guardian	< 1%
The New York Times	3%
The Providence Journal	< 1%
The Wall Street Journal	< 1%
The Washington Post	< 1%
WJAR (Channel 10)	5%
WPRI (Channel 12)	13%
WPRO	< 1%
I prefer to learn from social media sites, Google News, Apple News, online influencers, friends, or families	12%
Other	4%



Section 6: Life in Rhode Island

How satisfied are you with the overall quality of life in Rhode Island?

Response option	Percent
Very satisfied	13%
Somewhat satisfied	40%
Neither satisfied nor dissatisfied	22%
Somewhat dissatisfied	17%
Very dissatisfied	9%

What do you think about the state of the Rhode Island economy these days? Would you say the state of the Rhode Island economy is...

Response option	Percent
Very strong	2%
Somewhat strong	20%
Neither strong nor weak	39%
Somewhat weak	26%
Very weak	12%

Blue economy initiatives

Respondents used a 0–100 slider (0 = less investment, 100 = more investment). The table reports mean scores.

Initiative	Mean
Commercial fishing	52
Aquaculture	53
Offshore wind energy	52
Marine tourism	52
Recreation	56
Maritime defense	50
Ports and shipping	58



Section 7: Trust and Community

Please indicate the degree to which you agree with the following statements:

Statement	Strongly agree	Somewhat agree	Neither	Somewhat disagree	Strongly disagree
I feel connected to my community.	14%	35%	33%	11%	6%
I feel empowered to make changes within my community.	11%	27%	40%	15%	8%
I spend time with people of different racial, ethnic, or cultural backgrounds from my own.	34%	34%	25%	4%	3%
I am similar to my neighbors in terms of values and beliefs.	14%	33%	37%	12%	4%
I am similar to my neighbors in terms of political views.	9%	25%	46%	16%	5%
I trust my neighbors.	21%	40%	26%	7%	7%
I am comfortable discussing local and state issues with community members who have different political beliefs than I do.	18%	31%	29%	15%	7%



How much trust do you have in each of the following levels of government?

Level of government	A great deal	A fair amount	Not very much	None at all
The local government where you currently live	10%	52%	29%	8%
The Rhode Island state government	9%	48%	30%	14%
The United States federal government	6%	33%	39%	22%

How much trust do you have in each branch of the Rhode Island government?

Branch	A great deal	A fair amount	Not very much	None at all
The state executive branch headed by the Rhode Island Governor	6%	43%	32%	19%
The state judicial branch headed by the Rhode Island Supreme Court	9%	52%	27%	12%
The state legislative branch, consisting of the members of the Rhode Island General Assembly	7%	50%	25%	18%

Which of the following identities describes you the best?

Response option	Percent
American	24%
New Englander	24%
Rhode Islander	41%
Resident of your current or former local city or town	7%
Other	4%

Would you say that you live in an urban, suburban, or rural community?

Response option	Percent
Urban	27%
Suburban	57%
Rural	15%



How many of the people running the Rhode Island state government are corrupt?

Response option	Percent
All	5%
Most	23%
About half	24%
A few	44%
None	4%

How big of a problem do you think political violence is in the U.S. today?

Response option	Percent
A very big problem	37%
Somewhat of a problem	44%
Not very much of a problem	12%
Not a problem	2%
Not sure	5%



Section 8: Demographics

"Prefer not to say" is not included; totals may not add up to 100%.

Sex	
Response option	Percent
male	48%
female	52%

Race	
Response option	Percent
White	78%
Black	8%
Hispanic	6%
Asian	5%
Native American	< 1%
Middle eastern	< 1%
Two or more races	2%
Other	< 1%

Hispanic	
Response option	Percent
Yes	13%
No	87%

Education	
Response option	Percent
No HS	6%
High school graduate	33%
Some college	14%
2-year	11%
4-year	22%
Post-grad	14%



Family Income

Response option	Percent
<40K	30%
40–100	32%
>100	31%

What is your present religion, if any?

Response option	Percent
Protestant	14%
Roman Catholic	34%
Mormon	< 1%
Eastern or Greek Orthodox	< 1%
Jewish	2%
Muslim	< 1%
Buddhist	1%
Hindu	< 1%
Atheist	8%
Agnostic	9%
Nothing in particular	28%
Something else	4%

Which of the following best describes your current sexual orientation?

Orientation	%
Straight/heterosexual	84%
Bisexual	7%
Gay or Lesbian	4%
Asexual	<1%
Pansexual	1%
Queer	<1%
If not listed above, please specify	1%
Prefer not to answer	2%

Do you identify as transgender?

Response option	Percent
No, I do not identify as transgender	96%
Yes, I do identify as transgender	1%
I am not sure if I am transgender	1%



Children under 18 in household

Response option	Percent
Yes	23%
No	77%

Party ID

Response option	Percent
Democrats/Independents leaning Democrats	51%
Republicans/Independents leaning Republicans	30%
Independents	18%

Registered to vote

Response option	Percent
Registered	88%

